

Anti-Bullying Policy

A safe environment, free from bullying, for every young person

15-17 Irlam Road, Bootle, Liverpool, L20 4AE · Alternative Provision for Ages 5–25

ADOPTED POLICY

This policy has been formally adopted by L-Fit Pathways' co-directors and is in effect from the date shown below. Any section still shown in [square brackets and amber text] is organisation-specific detail that remains to be confirmed and inserted - it does not affect the rest of the policy's validity but should be completed as soon as possible.

Version: 1.0 (Adopted)

Date Adopted: 16 September 2026

Next Review Due: 16 September 2027 (or sooner following any legislative change or relevant incident)

1. Statement of Intent

L-Fit Pathways is committed to providing an environment where every young person feels safe, valued and able to take part fully. Bullying of any kind, including peer-on-peer abuse, is not tolerated.

2. Legal & Statutory Framework

- Keeping Children Safe in Education (KCSIE) 2026, Part 5 — Child on Child Abuse
- Equality Act 2010
- Working Together to Safeguard Children (2026)

3. What Is Bullying?

Bullying is behaviour that is repeated, intended to hurt someone physically or emotionally, and often aimed at certain groups. It can be physical, verbal, emotional, or take place online (cyberbullying), and includes behaviour targeted at a protected characteristic.

4. Prevention

- Group sessions (Forest School, Boxing Fitness, AAL) are actively supervised, with group dynamics monitored by staff throughout
- Young people are supported to understand respectful behaviour as part of every provision, not as a standalone lesson
- Staff model and reinforce inclusive, respectful language and behaviour at all times

5. Responding to Bullying

- Any incident is taken seriously, and both the young person affected and the young person responsible are supported
- Incidents are recorded, with parents/carers and referring professionals informed

- Our approach follows the relational, trauma-informed model set out in our Behaviour Management Policy — understanding the cause of the behaviour while being clear it is not acceptable
- Where bullying involves a safeguarding risk (e.g. repeated targeted abuse, online bullying, abuse relating to a protected characteristic), it is escalated under our Safeguarding & Child Protection Policy

6. Roles & Responsibilities

All staff are responsible for challenging bullying behaviour when they see it. The Designated Safeguarding Leads, Adam Byrne and Craig Lloyd, hold overall responsibility for this policy.

7. Monitoring & Review

This policy is reviewed annually, or sooner following a significant incident.

Policy adopted on: 16 September 2026 — Next review due: 16 September 2027